

Employee A, B and C.

Phase one involves hiring two experienced staff members, B and C, for a single training day on a Monday. This will be classed as an unpaid trial shift. Following this, an initial probation period excluding staff to take a week's holiday (length to be determined) will see employee B and C temporarily contracted to 18 hours per week, working solely alongside employee A each day. Post-probation hours will be split evenly between front-of-house staff, resulting in 24 hours per week (4 days a week).

Phase two will see staff rostered accordingly to meet training needs. Initially, employee A will always be present with either B or C on Saturday and Sunday shifts until the full training period is completed. During the post-probation period, B and C will only be paired for weekday shifts to build confidence and experience in a less busy environment. Employee A will be partially present or available remotely if needed.

Phase three will see all staff trained equally and working in a flexible structure, eventually reflected in a fair rota.

All rotas will be managed by employee A and holiday requests will be handled by them. Employee contracts will include annual leave obligations. (A, B or C can't take annual leave at the same time. Annual leave must be pre-approved four weeks in advance. Management will allocate annual leave at their discretion within reason.) Each staff member is entitled to 123 hours of annual holiday leave, 1 week off equating to 24 hours used.

Any employee's personal commitments or appointments will be managed within the monthly rotas. Short-notice medical absences should be arranged between staff a day in advance to allow time for cover if possible. Any missed shifts will be redistributed within the monthly rota to balance hours.

When a member of staff is on holiday for a week, the remaining employees cover the 24 hours as agreed in the contract, so over a 11-month period, staff would typically work 27 hours a week (on average), with a minimum of 24 and a maximum of 36 hours, unless agreed otherwise by management. To book a full weekend off, an employee uses 6 hours of annual holiday leave, which aligns with the minimum of 1 weekend day worked per week.

Holiday leave in the first year of employment has to be accrued before taken, and ideally be taken in 1 or 2-week blocks. Longer consecutive periods require approval. These blocks are covered by remaining staff, as agreed in the contract. For Ramadan, amended hours apply, and staff discuss operational logistics on a preference basis. Staff are entitled to an unpaid 20-minute break per shift, either as 20 minutes or two 10-minute breaks. (Including this break saves up to £3129 annually by reducing daily hours and accrued holiday hours.) Staff are paid from 9am to 3:20pm, excluding their unpaid break, for a total of 6 hours per day. All end-of-day and start-of-day procedures are accounted for in this time.

Annual hours paid out including holiday pay required to cover both a two/three staff model are approximately 3595 (for three staff £13,661 per employee / or total £41,000 including reduction from unpaid breaks). For simplicity, staff could be paid a fixed monthly average of £1242 (£13,661 divided by 11). If staff leave the position before the full 11-month cycle, to balance this the hours owed can be deducted from their last monthly wage.

Alternatively to reduce contracted hours a second a more complex 3-staff rota is possible. This would see the second member of staff start their shift at 10am; reducing 2 hours a week per employee, saving £3235, and roughly saving £400 in accrued holiday pay. This difference deducted from the first model would bring total annual wage outgoings down to roughly £37,400. It would be too complex implementing the set monthly wage in this instance, as periods with new staff starting on the second hour of opening hours would effect the even split of hours between staff; a simpler way to pay employees in this format would be to tally total hours worked each month. The result of this would be higher/lower wage costs in each month depending on holiday periods (capping at £4100 for a highest total possible if staff are off consecutively for 4 weeks in a given month, with the lowest possible being £3000, with each staff working 22 hours a week in a month with no holiday leave taken).

Benefits of this model include:

- A self-sustaining system.
- Longer-term stability.
- Shift patterns that suit both long-term and short-term employment.
- A competitive and appealing job opportunity that increases applications and improves the chances of finding good candidates.
- Less disruption in holiday periods / when staff move on or unavoidable short-term absences occur.
- All holidays managed in-house and covered by in-house staff.
- All front-of-house employees will be brewch-trained baristas, which benefits the franchise by providing more shift cover opportunities and overtime.
- A leaving staff member will work reduced hours in a four-week notice period, allowing new staff to be trained simultaneously and ensuring smooth transitions / new staff always working with fully trained staff.
- A refreshing experience for regular customers.

Normal weekly rotation example (x = day off)

Week 1	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A		X				X
B			X		X	
C	X			X		

Week 2	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A	X			X		
B		X				X
C			X		X	

Week 3	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A			X		X	
B	X			X		
C		X				X

Week 4	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A		X			X	
B			X			X
C	X			X		

Holiday month rotation example. (H = holiday)

Week 1	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A						
B	H	H	H	H	H	H
C						

Week 2	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A					X	H
B		X	X			
C	X			X		

Week 3	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A			X	X		
B	X				X	
C		X				X

Week 4	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
A	X					X
B		X		X		
C			X		X	